RIVERSIDE PHYSICAL THERAPY & SPORTS REHAB
Home Exercise Program

Patient: J. Whitlock
Therapist: Nadia Brennan, PT, DPT
Diagnosis: Patellofemoral pain syndrome, right knee
Date issued: January 19
Frequency: once daily, 5-6 days per week, unless otherwise noted

General guidance:
Mild discomfort during exercise (up to 3 out of 10) is acceptable and expected. Pain should settle within 24 hours. If pain exceeds 5/10 or you notice swelling the next day, reduce the number of sets by half and contact the clinic. Avoid de ep squatting, kneeling, and running downhill for the next 3-4 weeks.

PHASE 1 (Weeks 1–2)

1. Quad sets
Sit with your leg straight. Tighten the thigh muscle, pressing the back of your knee down into the floor. Hold 5 seconds. 2 sets of 15.

2. Straight leg raises
Lie on your back, opposite knee bent. Tighten the thigh, lift the straight leg t o the height of the bent knee. Lower slowly. 3 sets of 12.

3. Side-lying hip abduction (clamshell progression)
Lie on your side, bottom knee bent. Lift the top leg, keeping it straight and sl ightly behind you, toes pointing forward. 3 sets of 12 each side. Add ankle weig ht (2 lb) when easy.

4. Glute bridges
Lie on your back, knees bent, feet flat. Squeeze the glutes and lift hips to for m a straight line from shoulders to knees. Hold 3 seconds. 3 sets of 10.

5. Wall sit (partial)
Back against wall, slide down only to a 45° knee bend (NOT 90°). Hold 20-30 seco nds, 4 repetitions.

PHASE 2 (Weeks 3–4, if pain-free with Phase 1)

6. Step-downs (eccentric)
Stand on a 4-6 inch step on the right leg. Slowly lower the left heel toward the floor over 3 seconds, keeping the right knee aligned over the second toe (do no t let it cave inward). 3 sets of 10.

7. Monster walks with band
Band around ankles, slight squat, walk sideways 10 steps each direction. 3 round s.

8. Box squats to bench height
Sit back to a bench and stand without using hands. 3 sets of 8. Progress by addi ng a dumbbell held at the chest.

9. Single-leg balance
Stand on the right leg for 30 seconds, 3 times. Progress to eyes closed or stand ing on a pillow.

Stretching (daily):
- Standing quad stretch, 30 seconds x 3
- Hamstring stretch, 30 seconds x 3
- IT band / foam roller to outer thigh, 1-2 minutes (avoid rolling directly on t he knee)

Return to running: Begin walk-run intervals (1 min run / 2 min walk x 8) when you can perform 15 pain-free single-leg step-downs. Next appointment: February 2, 8:15 a.m.